

STEPHEN ANDREW STAKER

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Backend and platform engineer with 13+ years designing event-driven systems, modernizing legacy integrations, and shipping production-grade software in regulated healthcare and benefits administration. Most recently led architecture and delivery for a real-time insurance carrier integration platform (REST APIs, Kafka, LIMRA LDEX/BEM) while managing the engineering teams building it. Stays actively hands-on through a daily AI-augmented development practice using Claude Code agentic workflows.

SKILLS

Backend and Systems: Backend Service Design, Event-Driven Architecture (Kafka, RabbitMQ), API-First Design (REST, GraphQL), Data Pipelines and ETL, System Reliability and Observability, Legacy System Modernization, Microservices, Domain-Driven Design

Technologies: Java, Spring Boot, PHP, Python (FastAPI, Celery), C#, .NET, TypeScript, JavaScript, React, Next.js, Flutter, Kafka, Redis, MySQL, PostgreSQL, Docker, Git, Splunk, Opsgenie, Jira

AI and Automation: Claude Code, AI-Augmented Development, Agentic Workflows (PO/Dev/QA Agent Orchestration), Prompt Engineering, AI-Assisted Code Review

Domain Expertise: Healthcare Compliance, Benefits Administration, ACA Reporting, COBRA, Insurance Carrier Integration, EDI, LIMRA LDEX / BEM Data Standards, Direct Primary Care (DPC)

Technical Leadership: Architectural Oversight, Technical Mentorship, Cross-Functional Collaboration, Code Review Culture, Incident Response, Hiring and Onboarding

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Paycom | Oklahoma City, OK | 2013 – March 2026

Manager of Software Development (2023 – March 2026) · Technical Lead (2018 – 2023) · Team Leader, Benefits Administration Platform (2015 – 2018) · Software Developer (2013 – 2015)

- Led engineering for a strategic real-time insurance carrier integration platform that replaced legacy batch-based EDI exchanges with REST APIs and Kafka event streams, reducing data latency and improving partner onboarding velocity.
- Architected Kafka-based event-driven systems enabling near real-time data transmission, downstream processing, and improved observability across compliance-critical workflows.
- Implemented LIMRA LDEX / BEM data models for compliant enrollment and coverage data exchange across carrier partners.
- Led modernization of monolithic applications into API-first service architectures, reducing deployment coupling and improving release velocity.
- Designed batch processing pipelines and nightly jobs supporting regulatory data generation for ACA and benefits reporting.
- Drove technical direction across a 20+ project portfolio while managing 30+ engineers and 16 QA analysts across three regulated product domains (ACA, Benefits Administration, COBRA); founded and scaled multiple backend engineering teams with structured hiring, onboarding, and mentorship.

TECHNICAL PROJECTS

java-spring-kafka-react | Java 17, Spring Boot, Kafka (Redpanda), PostgreSQL, React, TypeScript, Docker

- Full-stack event-driven demo: REST API message creation, Kafka event publishing and consumer processing, PostgreSQL persistence, and idempotency-key support for safe retries. React + TypeScript frontend with TanStack Query for server-state caching. Fully containerized via Docker Compose.

Agentic Development Practice | Claude Code, Python, Healthcare-Adjacent Compliant Software

- Operate a daily multi-agent Claude Code workflow with dedicated PO (Product Owner), Dev, and QA agents building compliant healthcare-adjacent software. PO agents decompose requirements, Dev agents generate production-grade code, QA agents validate correctness before merge.
- Apply prompt engineering and AI-assisted code review across regulated, event-driven systems; evaluate tooling across Claude Code and GitHub Copilot as part of active practice.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science, Computer Science | University of Central Oklahoma

Academic Performance Award (2014) · Research Assistant, Neural Network Mobility Analytics